

Redmi Note 15

Still the default recommendation?

For over a decade, the Redmi Note series has been the default recommendation for the Indian middle class. It wasn't always the flashiest phone, but it was the one that was reliable enough, the one you bought for your parents, your college-going cousin or yourself when you needed utility over vanity.

But the market in early 2026 is hostile. The sub-25,000 segment is no longer just about "value"; it is a spec-war where brands are tossing around flagship-tier hardware to see what sticks.

Into this fray walks the Redmi Note 15. On paper, it is playing a safer game. It isn't trying to out-benchmark the performance-focused sub-brands or dazzle with design gimmicks. Instead, it doubles down on the dependability factor with lighter weight, better endurance, a cleaner camera setup and software that suggests Xiaomi expects this phone to stay in someone's pocket for years and not mere months.

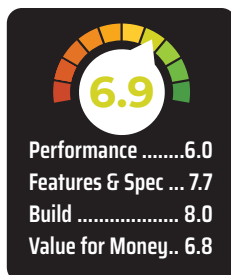
So, in a segment that's obsessed with proving how fast a phone can be for five minutes, is there still space for a phone that wants to be steady? That's what the Redmi Note 15 wants to answer.

DESIGN AND BUILD

Pick up the Redmi Note 15 and the first thing you notice about it is that it has gone on a diet. One of the biggest complaints with the previous Note 14 was its heft; at 190g and 8mm thick, it felt substantial, sometimes borderline bulky. The Note 15 trims that down to 7.35mm and drops the weight to 178g.

That 12-gram difference might sound rather trivial on a spec sheet, but in hand, this is a phone that doesn't tug at

₹22,999



your pocket or fatigue your fingers if you spend hours checking and replying to emails, reading, or navigating with one hand on public transport.

I am using the Mist Purple variant and while the frame remains plastic, it has a really clean finish.

There's no flex when you press down near the centre and the matte finish resists fingerprints better than glossy backs in this segment.

The camera module is large and square, with the 108MP branding slapped across its face. The layout is symmetrical, but when placed on a table, there is a slight wobble, though it's not exaggerated.

The Note 14 settled for an IP64 rating, but the Note 15 bumps this to IP66, protecting it against "powerful water jets." Effectively, this means you can use it in heavy rain or spill a drink on it without panic. It's worth remem-

bering that lab certifications aren't magic shields, but this phone is meant to survive clumsiness.

However, this slimming process is not without casualty. The 3.5mm headphone jack, which was present on the Note 14, is now gone. For the loyalists who held onto the Note series specifically for access to wired audio, this is the end of the road.

DISPLAY

We are at a point where bad displays are rare, but mediocre ones are everywhere. The Note 15 stretches the canvas slightly, moving from the 6.67-inch panel of its predecessor to a 6.77-inch AMOLED.

The Note 14 peaked at 2100 nits, which was already respectable. The Note 15 pushes this to a theoretical 3200 nits. Let's be clear about what that number means: that is a localised peak for HDR content, generally done at 1% window, not what you get when you open your email. However, in daily use, the panel holds its own and in our lab testing, the display brightness peaked at 1670 nits.

I used the phone under direct afternoon sun and maps, notifications and text remained legible without forcing the brightness slider to max manually. The auto-brightness behaviour is reasonably aggressive, which helps.

The 120Hz refresh rate is standard, but the touch sampling rate (up to 480Hz in gaming) makes the UI feel stickier and more responsive to your thumbs than the Note 14's panel.

In our Calman Grayscale Multi test, the display delivered a contrast ratio of 114,774:1. Black luminance measured at 0.005 cd/m², which is effectively inky. That shows up immediately when you watch darker content or browse through night-mode photos. Blacks don't float into grey, they sit deep and stable and shadow-heavy scenes carry more depth instead of looking washed out.

Colour accuracy is stronger than I expected at this price. The average colour error in the ColorChecker